

CARDIOVASCULAR SYSTEM

The heart, an intricate network of vessels, and the blood circulating through them make up your cardiovascular system.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Your heart constantly beats to pump blood around your body, removing waste and delivering vital oxygen. Research on yoga suggests profound benefits for cardiovascular health, including a reduced risk of heart disease. Yoga has been shown to clinically improve blood pressure, cholesterol levels, and cardiovascular resilience (see opposite).

Red blood cells

Also called erythrocytes, they deliver oxygen

White blood cells

Also called leukocytes, they fight invaders

Platelets

Also called thrombocytes, they help blood to clot

Composition of blood

Adults have about 11 pints (5 liters) of blood circulating around the body. Blood is a connective tissue composed of red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets suspended in a liquid called plasma. It provides oxygen, nutrients, and hormones, as well as removing waste from cells.

